

# **Coral Gems Athletics**

## **2026-2027 Handbook & Guidelines**

### **Introduction**

Welcome to our 4th season! We are so grateful that you've chosen to be a part of the Coral Gem Athletics family and made this commitment.

This handbook is your resource for all the essential information about our program. Inside, you'll find details on costs, commitment policies, attendance expectations, uniform guidelines, travel information, competition commitments, payment policies, important dates, expected athlete behavior, a tentative schedule, USASF rules and guidelines, and an introduction to our coaching staff.

**We're excited for a fantastic season ahead!**  
**Become a Gem this season; Strong, Rare, & Unbreakable**

### **Our Mission**

At Coral Gems Athletics, we are dedicated to empowering every athlete to reach their fullest potential. We offer fully inclusive All-Star Cheer & Dance programs in the SWFL area. We foster a safe, respectful, and competitive environment. Our coaches emphasize positive reinforcement and sportsmanship while providing top-notch training & spotting. We take immense pride in the trust our community places in us and are committed to protecting, teaching, and guiding our athletes in a manner that honors that trust.

With each athlete, every practice, and every competition, our primary goal is to uplift and support our athletes. Our coaching team is devoted to nurturing their growth both athletically and personally. Our program transcends mere competition; it's about mentoring our athletes to develop their skills to further their futures in their sport! At CGA, we recognize that our athletes' mental health is just as vital as their physical health. By prioritizing both, we ensure our athletes stand out like true Gems! We believe that the bonds and lessons formed through this sport will last a lifetime, creating cherished memories, experiences, & connections for years to come. Our athletes are more than just names on a roster; they become part of our family.

***Together, we can create a supportive and successful environment for all members.***  
***Thank you for your dedication!***

# **Cape Coral Gems Rules and Policies:**

**Parents and athletes should always be respectful and courteous to others. A positive attitude & good sportsmanship are integral parts of the All-Star program. The behaviors below as well as all others mentioned in this handbook encourage teamwork and must be followed:**

1. Maintain a positive attitude and demonstrate good sportsmanship at all times.
2. Communicate openly and respectfully with coaches, the director, and the owner regarding any concerns or issues.
3. All social media comments related to Cape Coral Gems, team members, or other gyms must be positive. Negative comments are not permitted and are grounds for dismissal or legal action.
4. Absolutely no gossiping, bullying, or exclusion of other teammates, teams, programs, or staff.
5. The use of tobacco, alcohol, or drugs is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate dismissal from the squad & legal action if required.
6. Any form of abusive behavior, dishonesty, or negative conduct will lead to dismissal & legal action if required. Disrespect of any staff member of any kind may be grounds for removal from our program.
7. Adhere to all rules and guidelines set forth by coaches or authorized personnel these rules are not to be challenged.
8. Respect the facility and its equipment. Always clean up after yourself and set a positive example for others.
9. Outside shoes are not permitted on the mats.
10. Wear appropriate practice attire.
11. Jewelry is not allowed during practice, tumbling classes and competition.
12. Food, gum, and beverages other than water are prohibited on the gym floor.
13. Use of profanity or abusive language is not tolerated.
14. No one is allowed on the floor until the coach calls the team or class.
15. Spectators are not permitted on the gym floor during practice to ensure the safety of all athletes.

## **All-Star Cheerleading Commitment and Attendance Policy**

To ensure the success and cohesion of our All-Star Cheerleading team, it is essential that all members commit to attendance at all practices and competitions. Consistent participation not only helps each individual improve but also strengthens the entire team as we work together toward our goals.

If you anticipate being unable to attend a practice or competition, please notify your coaches as soon as possible. This includes absences due to illness, family commitments, travel plans, or school events.

Clear communication is key, and we appreciate your efforts to keep us informed.

An absence due to injury will require a doctor's note of clearance to return to practice and or competition. An absence due to illness that required doctors' attention will also require a note of clearance to return from the Dr.'s office. We reserve the right to request physician's clearance when deemed necessary by our coaching staff.

Please be aware that excessive absences can have serious consequences. If a member misses too many practices without valid reasons, it may lead to removal from the team and the forfeiture of competition fees. We want everyone to succeed and be part of this amazing experience, so let's all strive to maintain our commitment to the team.

## **Uniforms:**

Uniform fittings are TBD and mandatory for all athletes. Gym approved Cheer shoes should only be worn at practice and during competitions so they will hold up for the entire season. Uniforms must be worn only at competitions/Showcases/dress rehearsal.

## **Traveling:**

The parent/guardian will be responsible for any traveling the team will be doing. You will be responsible for getting your child to and from practices, clinics, and competitions. If you plan on carpooling or having your child travel with another parent/guardian, please let the coaches know the arrangement.

## **USASF & Varsity Age Grid**

**All cheer and dance athletes on a competition team will be required to become a member of USASF. To join visit <https://www.usasfmembers.net>**

Memberships run June 1 through May 31 of each season. There are many benefits to USASF membership including athletes' insurance and travel discounts.

Please see below the USASF 26-27 Age Grid. This is what we will be following. Our team size, level, and division will be based on who tried out.

Tiny 2019-2021 (Level 1 Only)

Mini 2017-2020 (level 1 & 2 ONLY)

Youth 2014-2019 (level 1-4)

Youth flex 2013-2021 (levels 1-3 ONLY)

Junior 2011-2018 (Levels 1-4)

Junior Flex 2010-2020 (level 1-3 Only)

Senior 6/1/2007-2014 (Levels 1-4)

Senior Open 5/31/2009 or Before (Level 4 ONLY)

## **Payment**

- Full Season is June through May. Tuition is divided evenly over the season. Monthly payments will begin June 1st and end with May payment for full season. Half season payment will be charged June through December and January through May.

Registration fees are due June 1<sup>st</sup> for full season & August and January 1<sup>st</sup> for half season.

- Payments accepted via card, cash, Venmo or check. There is a \$35 fee for checks returned nsf.
- Payments are due the first week of each month. Team athletes will be required to place an active payment card on file. All credit card payments will be processed on the 1st of every month. Please note it may take a few days for the transaction to reflect in your account. If you wish to pay in any form other than card on file, please inform us by the 28<sup>th</sup> of the prior month.
- A \$25 fee will be charged for late payments. Monthly fees are considered late on the 5th.

**Please be aware that your athlete's account must be kept current. If you are late on any payments (including monthly fees, uniforms, etc.), your child will not be allowed to participate in practice. Additionally, if there is an upcoming competition, your child will not be able to participate until the balance is paid.**



## Competition Participation Guidelines

- **\*\*Mandatory Participation:\*\*** All team members are required to participate in every competition. If the first competition arrives and teams are unprepared, we will wait. However, be aware that if any team is asked to advance, they will attend additional competitions.
- **\*\*Subject to Change:\*\*** Please note that all competitions have potential for change. If Coral Gems Athletics cancels a competition, we will strive to replace it with a comparable event and adjust fees accordingly. In cases where a competition company cancels, we will provide a replacement, and fees will roll over.
- **\*\*Schedule Posting:\*\*** The final competition schedule will be posted with specific dates as soon as it becomes available.
- **\*\*Supportive Environment:\*\*** We kindly request that all parents sit or stand together during competitions to cheer on our teams. We highly encourage showing support by wearing Coral Gems colors or competition shirts, if available.
- **\*\*Respectful Conduct:\*\*** We will not tolerate disrespectful attitudes or comments towards parents, athletes, gym staff or coaches. Upon arrival at the competition venue, athletes must be dressed in full uniform, hair and make-up.

## Team Guidelines

- **\*\*Arrive on time\*\***
- **\*\*Wear the designated uniform (top and bottom) \*\***
- **\*\*Gym approved cheer shoes and socks\*\***
- **\*\*Maintain styled hair and makeup\*\***
- **\*\*Always wear the designated apparel over your uniform\*\***
- **\*\*NO jewelry\*\***
- **\*\*Refrain from using nail polish\*\*** coaches reserve the right to ask that polish be removed.

## Intellectual Property, Logo Usage, and Official Roles:

We deeply appreciate the enthusiasm and passion of our Cheer Families, and we love seeing your gym pride! To help protect the gym's brand, please remember that all logos, trademarks, and branding materials belong to the gym. If you'd like to use any of these materials, you must first reach out to gym management for written permission. Using them without approval isn't allowed and may lead to follow-up action.

To protect the integrity of our gym, we are strictly enforcing the following rules regarding Intellectual Property and Official Titles. Our strict vendor relationships ensure that all safety standards, fabric quality, color matching, and design integrity meet our exact specifications. Controlling official titles ensures that our staff can manage teams safely and efficiently without communication confusion.

### 1. Trademark, Name and Logo Usage Policy

The Coral Gem Athletics name, logos, slogans, and unique team names and designs are the exclusive intellectual property of the gym. Parents, athletes, and family members are strictly prohibited from contacting uniform companies, apparel vendors, or independent graphic designers to create custom merchandise, practice wear, or uniforms using our logos or brand name.

**Official Merchandise Only:** All apparel and gear representing our gym must be approved, produced, and distributed directly through the Coral Gem Athletics administration.

**Design Protection:** Unauthorized use of our logo or brand identity on unapproved items—even if intended as a gift or for personal use—constitutes a violation of these guidelines. Please ask us first.

### 2. Official Roles and Gym Titles

Every role within our gym—from coaching staff to team moms, coordinators, and volunteers—is strategically assigned by the administration to ensure proper vetting, safety compliance, and clear lines of communication. Parents and family members may not claim, assign themselves, or use titles (e.g., "Team Manager," "Head Coordinator," "Coach's Assistant") that have not been officially granted to them in writing by the gym owners. No individual may represent themselves as a spokesperson, leader, or decision-maker for Coral Gem Athletics or its individual teams to outside vendors, event producers, or the public. To ensure fairness and maintain professionalism across our program, we will enforce compliance. Failure to adhere to these policies will result in immediate corrective action, which may include:

1 **First Offense:** A formal written warning and mandatory removal of the unauthorized items/titles.

2 **Second Offense:** Financial responsibility for any vendor cancellation fees incurred by the gym, and suspension of the parent/guardian from viewing practices or attending specific gym events.

3 **Severe or Ongoing Violations:** Dismissal of the family from Coral Gem Athletics, without a refund of tuition or fees paid.

If you have an idea for merchandise or wish to volunteer for an official role, please reach out to the us directly to discuss how to do so properly.

## Fundraising:

Fundraising plays a vital role in helping to cover some of the costs associated with participating in the cheerleading program. We strongly encourage your involvement in the various fundraising events held throughout the year. Coral Gems will not be leading most fundraising activities; rather, it is up to us as parents or parent volunteers to organize these efforts. The program may host fundraisers throughout the year, with proceeds directed towards gym upgrades, scholarships, and more. Funds raised from these events can help cover the individual monthly expenses of our athletes.

We hope to be able to begin a booster club this season details to follow.

## Important Fundraising Money Guidelines

- **\*\*Cashing Out Restrictions\*\***: Fundraising money cannot be cashed out if you do not complete the season for any reason. If a team member does not finish the season, the funds will be redirected towards finding a replacement and the team's overall fundraising efforts.
- **\*\*Year-End Fund Use\*\***: Any remaining fundraising money at the end of the year can be allocated for an end-of-season party or any unforeseen expenses that may arise.
- **\*\*Roll Over Options\*\***: Additionally, these funds can be carried over to the next season, beginning in 2027-28.

## All Star Coaches:

Coach Amy



Coach Faith



Coach D



## Tumbling Coaches:

Coach Amy , Coach Faith, & Coach Remy

## **Parent Volunteers Responsibilities Checklist**

If you would like to become a parent volunteer, please inform us.

1. Respond to basic inquiries
2. Provide support to the coaches as needed
3. Aid in planning and organizing fundraisers
4. Assist with booking hotel accommodations and travel arrangements
5. Support during the competition season
  - a. Coordinate competition gifts (not responsible for payment, but will help liaison with other parents and plan each gift)
6. Help organize team bonding events

Attend meetings with coaches and fellow volunteers

This year, we will not request cash donations from parents. Instead, we will ask for contributions of items needed for the competition gifts, events or team bonding events. However, if a parent wishes to give cash, that will certainly be accepted.

**We are all united in our commitment to our children and share the desire for them to have an incredible season!**

## Commitment 2026-2027 Season - Coral Gems Athletics

### ATHLETE:

I, \_\_\_\_\_, am committed to the 2026-2027 All-Star Season of Coral Gems Athletics. I acknowledge that the season begins on June 1, 2026, and concludes on May 31, 2027. I accept responsibility for attending all practices and competitions. All-Star Cheerleading demands complete dedication, and this commitment to the team is of utmost importance. Effective time management is essential; participation in other activities should be coordinated around cheer practice and competition schedules. The absence of even one member from practice can adversely affect the entire team. Punctuality is also crucial, allowing the team to warm up and stretch together before we start practice as a unit.

I have read and understood the Coral Gems Athletics 2026-27 Handbook.

Athlete's Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

### PARENT/GUARDIAN:

#### **Financial Commitment**

I acknowledge that I have reviewed the handbook and understand all Tuition/Fee Information and fully comprehend my commitment to Cape Coral Gems Athletics. I recognize that this commitment is for the 2026-27 All-Star competitive season. I am aware that any payments made will be forfeited if I decide to leave a team or if I am removed from the program due to violations. Additionally, there are no other refunds or credits upon leaving a team. Should I choose to depart, I must settle all outstanding fees; including but not limited to, competition or entry fees, uniforms or other merchandise that has been ordered, I will be responsible for these costs.

#### **Parental Obligations**

1. Ensure your son/daughter arrives on time and attends all practices and events.
2. Inform the coaches if the student will be late or absent from practice.
3. Regularly check in for any updates regarding the team.
4. Avoid relaying important information through others.
5. Fulfill all financial obligations promptly.
6. Keep parent portal account information current including all waivers.
7. Encourage and support your child to reach their full potential.
8. Understand that any negative behavior directed at a Cape Coral Gems member, our staff, or other gyms—through any medium—will lead to dismissal from the team without a refund.
9. Direct any concerns or complaints to the Director or Owner; side discussions with other members or coaches are considered inappropriate and grounds for removal from the program.

I have read, understand and agree to the Cape Coral Gems 2026-2027 Handbook's terms and conditions.

Child or Children's Names: \_\_\_\_\_

Parent Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_



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### **ATHLETE:**

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I have read and understood the Coral Gems Athletics 2026-27 Handbook.

Athlete's Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

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7. Encourage and support your child to reach their full potential.
8. Any negative behavior directed at a Cape Coral Gems member, The District YSA Gym, staff, or other gyms—through any medium—will lead to dismissal from the team without a refund.
9. Direct any concerns or complaints to the Director or Owner; side discussions with other members or coaches are considered inappropriate and grounds for removal from the program.

I have read, understand and agree to the Cape Coral Gems 2026-2027 Handbook's terms and conditions.

Child or Children's Names: \_\_\_\_\_

Parent Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Return this signed copy to Coral Gems

# Coral Gems Athletics

Please fill out this form completely. **PLEASE PRINT ALL INFORMATION** If you are registering more than one child, please list all names on this form.

## 1st Participant's Name

Last name: \_\_\_\_\_ First: \_\_\_\_\_ Age: \_\_\_\_\_ DOB: \_\_\_\_\_

## 2<sup>nd</sup> Participant's Name

Last name: \_\_\_\_\_ First: \_\_\_\_\_ Age: \_\_\_\_\_ DOB: \_\_\_\_\_

## 3rd Participant's Name

Your paragraph text

Last name: \_\_\_\_\_ First: \_\_\_\_\_ Age: \_\_\_\_\_ DOB: \_\_\_\_\_

## Parents/Guardian Information:

Name(s): \_\_\_\_\_

Address: \_\_\_\_\_

City: \_\_\_\_\_ State: \_\_\_\_\_ Zip: \_\_\_\_\_

Email: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone Number: \_\_\_\_\_

Additional emergency contact: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

## WAIVER OF LIABILITY RELEASE FORM

I am aware of the nature of this activity, and I hereby assume responsibility for \_\_\_\_\_ (list all Participant's Names use additional page if needed) to participate and to be photographed for publicity purposes. I will not hold The District YSA, LLC, Coral Gems Athletics, the coaches, or any party involved responsible in the case of an accident or injury as a result of this participation. I understand this completed form must be in possession prior to participation in this program.

**Parent/Legal Guardian Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

I give The District YSA / Coral Gems Athletics authorization to save this card on file and charge my card on file monthly or as necessary for tuition, classes or other fees. I understand tuition and recurring fees will process on the first of the month. Drop-in Classes may be charged the day of.

**Card Number:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Name on Card:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Exp:** \_\_\_\_\_ **CVC (3-4-digit Code):** \_\_\_\_\_

**Billing Address if different from above:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_